AVA BIRDWELL

Email | Phone | Current: Rockland, Maine

September 22, 2026

Dear [redacted] Hiring Team,

I am excited to apply for the Academic Lead position with [redacted] Boston Office. After collaborating with [redacted], Senior Program Coordinator of Academics at [redacted], and learning more about [redacted] mission and programs, I was inspired by the organization's commitment to long-term student support and community-building. With a strong background in youth engagement, education, and project management, I am eager to contribute to [redacted] community of students and staff. I am particularly motivated by the dynamic, relationship-driven nature of this role and the opportunity to make an impact on students' personal and academic growth.

Most recently, I have served as an Environmental Steward and Educator through Maine Conservation Corps (an AmeriCorps program) at Hurricane Island Center for Science and Leadership. In this role, I quickly learned new marine science curricula, adapted lessons to diverse learning levels, and designed original programming on erosion, histories of knot tying, and rope art. These experiences strengthened my ability to create engaging, student-centered learning environments, and I am excited to bring this creativity and adaptability to [redacted] academic and enrichment programming for middle and high school students. Through AmeriCorps, I also gained experience in volunteer outreach and management. I designed and coordinated a week-long volunteer event, created outreach materials, and facilitated logistics and activities for participants. Volunteers are an essential part of nonprofit work, and I look forward to building on this experience at [redacted], including recruiting academic volunteers, supporting their engagement, and fostering a welcoming, collaborative community for students, staff, and volunteers.

As the lead research assistant on the project: Broadening Access to Climate AI Innovation during my master's degree, I coordinated team meetings, managed project timelines, and conducted outreach to experts and community stakeholders to facilitate an interactive, day-long virtual workshop. Balancing these responsibilities alongside my coursework strengthened my organizational and communication skills. I am excited to apply these experiences to collaborating with the Boston Program Director, Directors of Post-Secondary Success and Career Success, community partners, and parents/guardians to ensure student success. Additionally, my formal accounting, financial, and data analytics coursework will support me in managing budgets, identifying trends, and analyzing data to improve [redacted] programs.

Beyond my research and education experience, I bring strong interpersonal and community-building skills from my work as a Salsa Instructor for the UVA Salsa Club and as a Zero Waste Ambassador. As a Salsa instructor, I helped plan weekly lessons, built rapport with students and community members, and communicated effectively across different languages and backgrounds. As a Zero Waste Ambassador I supported UVA's sustainability initiatives by ensuring clean compost streams and developing educational materials to promote waste reduction. These experiences enhanced my ability to speak publicly, engage diverse audiences, and collaborate towards shared goals. I look forward to applying these skills to support [redacted] mission.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to bring my organizational strengths, communication skills, and commitment to youth development to the Academic Lead role at [redacted].

Sincerely,
Ava Birdwell